Only one man saw it as his duty to attend to the corpse of the murdered Shah. Shuja's faithful water carrier, Mehtar Jan Khan Ishaqzai, who had followed Shuja into exile in Ludhiana, returned to the corpse late that night and remained next to it, guarding it from mutilation. The following morning he and another old retainer of the Shah's, 'Azim Gol Khan, the 'Arz-begi, helped prepare the corpse for burial. Working alone, the two men dug a shallow grave inside a ruined mosque near the place of the murder. This they covered with earth, and placed the King's palanquin on top. They also raised a small cairn of stones to mark the place of the murder.

Later that summer, the stones and the bloodstained palanquin were still lying where the two loyal retainers had left them.[72]

At the beginning of the twentieth century, the historian Fayz Mohammad was told that Shah Shuja Sadozai had eventually been laid to rest in the magnificent Mughal-style mausoleum of his father, Timur Shah. That may well be the case, and it seems probable that his sepulchre is one of three male graves in the basement of that building; but if so the grave remains unmarked, a measure of the Shah's standing in Afghanistan today.

Even in his own time, the victorious Barakzai view of the struggle between the two clans dominated the way the Afghans wrote about the war, not least because they were patronising the poets who did the writing. Maulana Hamid Kashmiri, for example, puts into the mouth of the Shah's assassin a speech which he shouts at the dying Shuja and which represents the Barakzai position on Shuja's legacy: 'O cruel tyrant!' he taunts. 'When were you ever Shah that you call yourself so?' And he adds:

'The country that bestowed upon you this title of Shah
You have destroyed by casting a shadow of doom

Drunk like a maddened elephant
You aided and abetted the Firangi forces

Devastation came to Ghazni and Kabul
Into every home reached the hand of oppression

You turned the land of Islam into the land of infidels
You made the marketplace of infidelity brisk and vigorous

Your outer garb is like that of holy pilgrims in Mecca